

FIELD LIBRARY / ACTION CHECKLIST

Evacuation

EVACUATION SHELTER / EDITION 2026-10-02

QUICK ANSWER / START HERE

Leave a threatened location while a safer route and destination are still available. Take people, pets, essential medicines, identification, shoes, water and phone power; do not delay for belongings. Confirm the route and a place to stay, tell a trusted contact, and avoid flooded, closed or actively dangerous roads. Do not wait for an order when immediate danger is evident. Radiation or airborne hazards may make sheltering safer than travel.

Do now.

**Confirm the order**

01

Check the official zone, deadline, route, shelter options, and whether the order includes your address.

**Gather people first**

02

Account for everyone and pets. Take required medication and medical supplies, documents, accessible equipment, keys, and a charged phone. Do not spend critical time packing extras.

**Choose a destination**

03

Go to a trusted contact or designated shelter outside the hazard area. Check pet rules, accessibility, and transport needs.

**Leave and report safely**

04

Use current official routes. Share your destination with an out-of-area contact, keep fuel in the vehicle if relevant, and do not return until authorities say it is safe.

Keep the plan moving.

IF HELP IS UNAVAILABLE

Choose a reachable destination with someone you trust, identify a second route, and agree on a check-in. Do not wait for transport that has not been confirmed. If the route is actively dangerous, compare the specific hazard of staying with the hazard of moving; shelter while reassessing if no safer route is available.

Watch for.

If a route is unsafe, do not force it. Follow current local instructions or contact emergency services for help. Some hazards, especially radiation fallout, can make immediate travel more dangerous than sheltering; follow the hazard-specific order.

People & practical needs.

Give dependents a written contact card and agree who stays with each person. Keep essential medicine and mobility equipment accessible

Next decision.

Make two destinations and more than one route in advance. Keep a small grab list by the door, especially for medications, pets, and items that cannot be prepacked.

YOUR SITUATION / PRIVATE WORKSHEET

TIME / LOCATION / CHANGING CONDITIONS

PEOPLE / ACCESS OR MEDICAL NEEDS

SOURCES / SCOPE / LIMITS

Source-linked civilian guidance, not independent clinical or specialist certification. U.S. references; emergency numbers and services differ. Training and product instructions remain essential.

[Ready.gov · Evacuation](#)

[Ready.gov · Make a plan](#)

Full guide: <https://ospreyzero.com/emergencies/evacuation/>